

Title: What to Do in the First 5 Minutes of an Emergency [Article]

Excerpt: In any case of a real medical emergency, the very first 5 minutes is crucial. During this short time frame you must be able to know what to do before professional help arrives, but you don't know what to do. So, what can you do to help and not make the situation worse?

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“AHHHH, I need help!” You hear from your friend who just tumbled down a staircase at the mall. You start to panic and your brain is screaming at you to do something. But what? In emergencies like this, the first five minutes matter more than most people may realize. It could be a bad fall, a car accident, or a very urgent medical crisis—it doesn't matter what kind of emergency. Instead, what actually matters is what you actually do in those minutes before professional help arrives, which can significantly impact the outcome. And most of the time, knowing some basic first aid can help you stay calm and be able to provide help to the victim. These first five minutes are highly crucial to help save your friend, a loved one, and others around you.

The first thing to do is to assess the situation and the person. Ensure the area is actually safe before you run in and do anything. According to the [American Red Cross](#), assessing the scene helps you provide better care for the victim and stops you from becoming another victim. For example, if your friend fell down the stairs, you should first look around for possible problems like broken objects or a crowded space. Then, check the person. Are they conscious? Breathing? Do they respond when you say their name? This tells you how serious the situation is and what you should do next.

After checking, you need to call for help. Calling 911 as soon as possible ensures that emergency responders are on the way, and it's especially important to do so if the person is unresponsive or in a life-threatening emergency. When calling, stay calm and explain where you are, what happened, and the person's condition. The [Mid-Atlantic Emergency Medical](#)

[Associates](#) notes that catching warning signs early on is what determines the kind of care someone actually needs, so provide as many details as you can. Dispatchers are actually trained to help you through what to do while you wait. So put the phone on speaker and listen to them. And even if you're not sure if the situation is actually serious enough for a 911 call, it's always better to call than regret it and potentially cause the person to be in a worse condition.

While you wait for help, care for the person. You can keep them still after a fall, applying pressure to a wound, or helping them stay conscious. These simple actions in the first five minutes can actually help stop the situation from getting worse while waiting for professionals. Sometimes the best thing you can do is just stay with them, calm them down, and not make any unnecessary movement so the situation doesn't get worse. None of these actions is that complicated, but having something to do can calm down you and the person.

The first five minutes of an emergency are stressful, but staying calm and remembering what to do is important. An acronym that can help you remember what to do in the first five minutes is CCC, which stands for the "check, call, care" method from the [American Red Cross](#). If you check the scene, call for help, and care for the person, you can actually make a real difference—good or bad—before 911 comes. In the first crucial five minutes, these small steps are super important in helping save others.